



ORACLE FUSION CLOUD

Approvals Overview

BPM Worklist vs. FSM · Serial & Parallel Routing · Approval Rule Design

Payables

Procurement

Expenses

Journals

HCM

Generic reference deck for implementation & functional teams

What Is Approval Management?

The engine that routes Oracle Fusion transactions to the right approvers

Oracle Fusion Cloud uses Approval Management Extensions (AMX), built on the Oracle BPM / SOA Suite, to route business documents — invoices, purchase orders, expense reports, journals, HR actions — through one or more approvers before the transaction becomes effective. Rules can be authored either in the simplified FSM approval pages or directly in BPM Worklist for advanced control.



Used consistently across Financials, Procurement, Expenses, and HCM modules

FSM vs. BPM: Two Ways to Configure Approvals

Same approval engine, two entry points — pick based on rule complexity

FSM

Functional Setup Manager

- Simplified UI inside Setup & Maintenance (e.g. Manage Requisition / Expense Approval Rules)
- Best for standard, condition-based rules — amount, category, cost center
- Fast to configure; no BPM Worklist access required
- Limited to seeded attributes and simpler condition logic
- Typical for Procurement, Expenses, and basic Payables rules

BPM

Worklist / Approval Mgmt. Extensions

- Full rules engine (AMX) accessed via BPM Worklist for advanced control
- Required for complex logic — DFFs, multi-attribute, custom conditions
- Supports advanced list builders, multiple stages and participants
- Requires Financial Application Administrator role
- FSM-authored rules sync down and remain visible in BPM

Most implementations start in FSM and move to BPM only when requirements exceed FSM's configuration options.

Approval Routing Types

How a participant's approver list is notified and resolved

SERIAL

Approvers are notified one at a time, in sequence. Typically used for supervisory, position, or job-level hierarchy routing where each level must sign off in order.

PARALLEL

All approvers are notified at the same time. With “First Responder Wins,” the first approve/reject action decides the outcome for the group — common with approval groups.

FYI

A notify-only participant. Recipients are informed but cannot approve or reject, and the approval process is not blocked waiting on them.

SINGLE / NAMED

The task is routed to one specific, named individual rather than a role, hierarchy, or group — used when approval must always go to the same person.

List Builders — how the approver list is generated

1

Supervisory Hierarchy

Ascends the manager chain from the requester

2

Position Hierarchy

Routes based on defined position structure

3

Job Level

Climbs the hierarchy until sufficient job level is found

4

Approval Groups

Predefined static or dynamic group of users

5

Named User

A specific, fixed individual approver

Choosing the Right Approach

Decision guide and implementation best practices

Use FSM when...

- Rules follow standard, seeded attributes (amount, category)
- Business users need to self-maintain rules
- Fast turnaround with minimal IT involvement is needed

Use BPM when...

- Custom / DFF-based conditions are required
- Complex multi-stage, serial + parallel combinations are needed
- Cross-module rule consistency and reuse matter

Implementation Best Practices

- 1 Map supervisory / position hierarchy and job levels before building rules
- 2 Use parallel routing for low-risk, high-volume transactions to speed cycle time
- 3 Use serial + job-level routing for high-value or escalation-sensitive approvals
- 4 Test rule precedence and edge cases with sample transactions before go-live
- 5 Maintain one source of truth — avoid conflicting edits across FSM and BPM